

Brother MFC-7840N

This Brother packs quite a punch

Brother is best known for value-for-money products. We look at one of its latest MFDs — the MFC-7840N.

This MFD has a basic two-line LCD backlit display. There is a full numeric keypad for the fax feature on the right and button options for fax, copy and print on the left.

The paper tray can be removed completely with three clamps to adjust your paper size — two on the sides and one on the back. There is also a tray on top of the device for ADF (Auto Document Feeder). The lid of the scanner can be extended when you need to scan a thick book.

Installation is simple — the toner cartridge assem-

bly slid into place very easily. Configuring the MFD can be being done without connecting it to a PC. Other than the many scanning options available, there's also a unique one — scan your document to FTP (upload to an FTP server).

For printing, we used two modes of the test documents — economy and standard. The plain Word documents took



11.5 seconds with an upper and lower limit of two seconds in both modes.

There was a difference of a second between the two modes, but the image quality was not that great in economy mode. The standard mode was an improvement, but a bit of pixelation was still visible. Scanning gave some good results with the scanned picture quality not that bad and it took a total of 36.4 seconds.

We also scanned five pages using ADF — this took a total of two minutes 35 seconds. A Word document was used to test the copying capabilities, which did not turn out that great as the text turned out to be a bit rough, but this could be caused by the scanner. Even so, the copying took only nine seconds.

This MFD with its ADF feature makes a good over-

all purchase. There are some minor features lacking, like a USB port to get instant printout from flash drives. This is still a really good buy, especially for small businesses, but is a bit on the pricey side at Rs. 19,895.

Specifications

250 sheet paper tray, 32 MB memory, Super G3 (33.6Kbps) modem, Upto 2,400 x 600 dpi print resolution.

Contact: Brother International (INDIA) Pvt. Ltd
Phone: 4098 8900
Email: info@brother.in
Website: www.brother.in
Price: Rs. 19,895

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

HP Photosmart C4588

A step towards wireless printing

HP is well known for its printing solutions, which include multifunctional devices. The HP Photosmart C4588 is a new MFD inkjet aimed at home users or small businesses, but also for those who want photo quality printing.

The C4588 is a neat looking MFD with its smooth clean look. There is a one-inch LCD colour display on the right surrounded by buttons. The paper support tray feels a bit weak and breakable. The scanner lid didn't feel very strong either.

When you power on this printer, it gives you step-by-step instructions on how to start installing the cartridges right up to print alignment — all on the LCD display itself. You do not

even need to connect the printer to the computer for these initials steps.

A unique feature of this printer is the WiFi support. You can either connect the printer to a network using a router or directly to a PC or laptop using ad-hoc networking. We ran the printer through a series of tests to check the print quality and speed in two modes — economy and standard. The

economy mode was quite unsatisfactory with very edgy lines in a full page text document as well as for a colour document. The standard mode, on the other hand, was a great improvement in terms of quality, but printing speed took a hit. The time difference between economy and standard for the test document (text) was 10 seconds, whereas the coloured document was a whole 30 seconds. The quality of the photo test turned out to be exceptionally good. It took



164 seconds for printing, which is decent. The scanning performance was average.

The HP Photosmart C4588 does live up to the mark for being a really good photo MFD as the photo printouts were very impressive.

Specifications

Dimensions: 17.09 x 11.42 x 6.38 in, Print resolution - 1200 x 2400 dpi, 32 MB memory, WiFi, MS/DUO, SD, XD, MMC card reader.

Contact: Hewlett Packard
Phone: 124 - 2566 111
Email: seema.dawar@hp.com
Website: www.hp.com/in
Price: Rs. 8,800

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Zebronics Air Gear

An MP3 player with no-strings attached

Zebronics has come up with an MP3 solution for wire free music as the Air Gear MP3 player is the headset itself.

The Zebronics Air Gear is worn behind the neck. These headphones look like Bluetooth headphones, and in fact, are the MP3 player itself. There is no device that needs to be plugged in to play music. The only time you need to connect the headphones to a wire is for charging or transferring music through the mini USB port located on the right earphone. All the controls are located on the right earphone. The power on/off and the play and pause buttons are all combined into one button, whereas the volume con-



We faced a frequent problem between switching songs and controlling the volume.

It is very delicate as the plastic neck band that holds the whole device

together looks very likely to break if not handled with care. This device will not survive a trip in your bag, if you intend to travel a crowded train or bus during peak hours.

There is no management in transferring music, as you can directly drag and drop the songs you want into the removable disk folder. There is no shuffle or repeat feature available with this player, which means you have to be very selective of the songs you want to listen to, or it will be a cumbersome task to look for that one particular song you feel like hearing.

Priced at Rs. 1,950, it's not the best of MP3 players. If the neck band was sturdier with a slight improvement in the sound quality,

we would recommend it to users who don't like wires, or to those who like listening to music while they exercise. So until an improved version of this wire free MP3 player comes out, we wouldn't suggest you buy it.

Specifications

Frequency range: 20 Hz - 20,000Hz, Max volume: 85dB, Supported Formats: MP3, WMA

Contact: Top Notch Infotronics (I) Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 9892084950
Email: padam.dugar@zebronics.com
Website: www.zebronics.com
Price: Rs. 1,950

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Norton Internet Security 2009

An efficient internet security suite

The Norton Internet Security suite comprises all the features of Norton Anti Virus with more features to protect users from threats on the internet like phishing web sites, key loggers, etc.

The look of the Norton Internet Security sports a very modern simplistic look. There are three quick access menus for Computer, Internet and Identity which are displayed when you open the program. There are also usage meters displayed on the main screen: one for CPU usage and the other for usage of the Norton Internet Security application.

Norton Internet Security integrates into your browser as a toolbar. Firefox and Internet Explorer have toolbars, but Opera isn't supported. The toolbar gives

quick access notifications for anti-phishing and also keeps security information like logins and passwords as profiles. Norton Internet Security allows users to securely store usernames and passwords, as well as create identity cards which help users in quick filling of online forms.

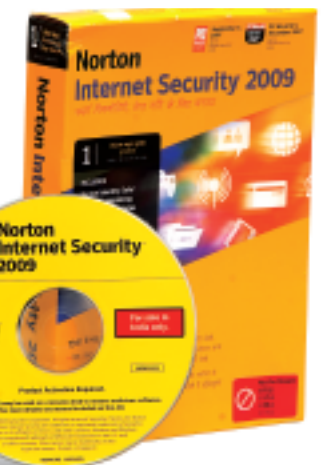
The earlier versions of Norton Anti Virus and Norton Internet Security used to use up a lot of resources which causing the PC to slow down when idle as well as during a system scan. But the Norton Internet Security 2009 has stepped up and is quite efficient when it come to resources. It used a maximum of 20 MB of RAM when we first installed it and while running a system scan it used about 10 MB of RAM. This is defi-

nately an improvement, as in the past the major problem with Norton was of users complaining of the amount of resources used when the antivirus was running.

Considering the all-in-one package that the Norton Internet Security offers — antivirus, antispyware, phishing filters for internet safety and even good performance, it is a bit on the expensive side at Rs. 2,115 for one year and hence we would not recommend it as there are others out there that are cheaper. Even so, if you are a Norton user and trust no other antivirus software then this is a great bundle for you.

Requirements

Microsoft Windows XP/Vista, 300 MHz or faster processor, 256 MB of RAM, 200 MB of



available hard disk space, Standard Web browser

Contact: Symantec
Phone: 1800 425 4235
Website: www.symantec.com/en/in/index.jsp
Price: Rs. 2,115

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★